ZZ-P-75B
December 3, 1971
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. ZZ-P-0075A
December 10, 1962 and
Fed. Spec. ZZ-P-75
March 30, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAD, TYPEWRITER, SPONGE RUBBER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sponge rubber compound for cushioning typewriters and other office machines.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes. Sponge rubber typewriter pads shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 10 inches wide by 12 inches long.
Size 2 - 14-1/2 inches wide by 14-1/2 inches long.
Size 3 - 15 inches wide by 16 inches long.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601/GEN - Rubber; sampling and testing.
Fed. Test Method 601/3021 - Hardness, Durometer.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, standards, and handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, standards, and handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7510

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Pads shall be made of a sponge rubber compound of natural rubber, or a suitable mixture of natural and synthetic rubber. The compound is referred to herein as sponge rubber. Natural rubber includes reclaimed rubber. The cells of the sponge rubber shall be reasonably uniform in size and character, and free from large voids or seams. The material shall be free of objectionable odor.

3.2 Construction for all pads. The pads shall be composed of one or more uniform horizontal layers of sponge rubber or of an alternate construction as hereinafter permitted. The top and bottom of the pad shall have rind surfaces. The sides shall be either rind surfaces or clean cut. A rind surface is the skin surface formed by contact with the mold. The top and bottom of the pad may be either plain or knurled, embossed, corrugated, grooved, or have a cloth finish, to provide increased resistance to sliding. The top and bottom surfaces shall be parallel.

3.2.1 Alternate constructions (standard typewriters).

3.2.1.1 The pad may have a raised section of firm, but not hard rubber securely cemented on each of the four corners of the pad to support the feet of the typewriter. Each raised section shall be so located with respect to the three other raised sections as to readily accommodate all standard makes of typewriters. The raised sections shall be uniform in dimensions and shall be not less than 1/4-inch in thickness over an area approximately 2 inches square (see 3.3).

3.2.1.2 The pad may be composed of a uniform inner layer of cotton felt, wool felt, or other suitable material, completely encased in molded sponge rubber. All exposed surfaces shall be rind surfaces.

3.2.1.3 The pad may be composed of molded sponge rubber and shall have a uniformly thin layer of cotton and/or wool felt cloth completely covering and securely cemented to the top surface.

3.2.1.4 The pad may include one or two thin layers of firm rubber or burlap or other fabric inserted between layers of sponge rubber, or cemented to one exposed surface. All layers of pads shall be securely cemented together.

3.2.1.5 The pad may be made with two layers. The top layer shall be of semi-hard rubber and the bottom layer shall be of sponge rubber. The sponge rubber layer shall be not less than 1/8-inch thick. The top layer shall have a closely and uniformly designed fluted, serrated, or corrugated exposed surface and shall be not less than 1/8-inch thick overall, with a minimum thickness of 1/16-inch, as measured from the bottom of the serrations, corrugations or flutes, to the bottom surface. The top layer shall have a durometer hardness of 60 to 80 when tested in accordance with 4.5.3. The exposed surface of the bottom layer of sponge rubber shall have a uniformly serrated or diamond or other suitable pattern to provide a gripping surface, so as to prevent slipping when supporting a typewriter.

3.2.2 Alternate construction (electrically operated typewriters). When specified, pads shall have both top and bottom surfaces uniformly knurled, fluted, embossed, corrugated, diamond shaped design, or other design which shall increase resistance to sliding or slipping of the typewriter and pad. The depth of the design on either surface shall be not less than 1/16 nor more than 3/32-inch when measured from the exposed surface.

3.3 Shape and dimensions. The top and bottom of the pad shall be approximately rectangular with either square or rounded corners. Sides and ends shall be beveled, rounded, or at right angles to the top surfaces, and shall be straight or fluted.

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3.3.1 Dimensions.

3.3.1.1 Size 1. Size 1 pads shall be not less than 12 inches in length, not less than 10 inches in width, and not less than 1/4-inch thick.

3.3.1.2 Size 2. Size 2 pads shall be not less than 14-1/2 inches in length and not less than 14-1/2 inches in width, and not less than 1/4-inch thick.

3.3.1.3 Size 3. Size 3 pads shall be not less than 16 inches in length and not less than 15 inches in width and not less than 1/2-inch thick.

3.4 Color. The color of the pads shall be uniformly either brown, gray, or black; or each layer of the pad may be a different solid color, but limited to the color specified herein.

3.5 Compression deflection. The pressure required to compress the pads 25 percent of normal thickness, shall be 9 to 20 pressure-pounds per square inch when tested in accordance with 4.5.1.

3.6 Compression set. The compression set when tested as specified in 4.5.2 shall be 25 percent, maximum.

3.7 Workmanship. The pad shall be well constructed and free from defects which affect appearance or may impair serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. For the purpose of sampling, a lot shall consist of all typewriter pads of the same size offered for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling of end item for visual defects. A random sample of typewriter pads shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 inspection level I. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one typewriter pad.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of interior packages, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery and selected just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 Sampling of end item for tests. A random sample of typewriter pads shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one typewriter pad.

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination of end item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective pads in the sample exceeds the acceptance for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE I. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
Material	Not as specified
Sponge rubber cell formation, construction and odor	Cells not uniform in size and character, not free from large voids or seams, not free of objectionable odor.
Construction	Not as specified.
Shape	Not as specified.

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TABLE I. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
Dimensions	Not as specified.
Color	Not as specified.
Workmanship	Defects which affect appearance or impair serviceability.

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure or container flaps, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

4.5 Tests. Prior to testing, samples shall be conditioned at room temperature for not less than 3 hours. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.2, shall be subjected to the following tests. Any pad failing one or more tests shall be considered a defective pad. If the number of defective pads exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.5.1 Compression deflection test.

4.5.1.1 Specimen. The specimen shall be a cylinder cut through the thickness of the pad with a circular die 1.129 inches in diameter, and shall be free from mechanical damage. The specimen shall be allowed to rest undeflected and undistorted for at least 12 hours before the testing.

4.5.1.2 Apparatus. The apparatus shall consist of a compression testing machine capable of compressing a specimen gently without impact at a uniform rate of 0.5 to 2 inches per minute. The machine shall be equipped with two horizontal metal plates at least 2 inches in diameter. The machine shall be equipped with a dial gage or equivalent, which will indicate the deflection of the specimen caused by application of the force to within 0.01 inch. The applied force shall be indicated in pounds to within plus or minus 1 percent of the dial or scale deflection. The apparatus may be machine or hand driven.

4.5.1.3 Procedure. The thickness shall be determined and then the specimen placed between the plates of the testing machine. The plates shall be just in contact with the specimen and the dial set at zero. The specimen shall be compressed to the required amount and the result recorded.

4.5.1.4 Calculations. The compression deflection of the specimen shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Compression deflection, pounds per square inch} = \frac{F}{1.0}$$

Where: F is the force required to deflect the specimen 25 percent in pounds.

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4.5.2 Compression set test.

4.5.2.1 Specimen. The specimen shall be prepared as specified in 4.5.1.1.

4.5.2.2 Procedure. The thickness of the specimen shall be determined to the nearest 0.005-inch and recorded as t_o. The specimen shall be compressed to 50 percent of its original thickness between flat metal plates. Then the specimen shall be heated in an air oven to a temperature of 70° C plus or minus 1° C. (158° F. plus or minus 1.8° F.) for 22 hours plus or minus 1/4-hour while under compression. After the specimen has been removed from the compression apparatus, the specimen shall be allowed to cool for 30 minutes and the thickness determined as before. The thickness shall be recorded as t_{30}.

4.5.2.3 Calculation. The compression set of the specimen, as percent of the original deflection, shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Compression set, percent of the original deflection} = \frac{t_o - t_{30} \times 100}{t_o - t_s}$$

Where: t_o is the thickness in inches of the specimen before compression.
t_{30} is the thickness in inches of the specimen 30 minutes after removal from compression.

t_s is the thickness in inches to which the specimen is compressed.

4.5.3 Durometer hardness. The pads shall be tested in accordance with No. 3021 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve (12) type I or type II pads shall be packaged in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, variety SW, grade optional. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specifications. Type III pads shall not require packaging.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve (12) type I or type II pads shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636 type CF, class domestic variety SW or DW. Each box shall be closed in accordance with Method II of the appendix to the box specifications. Type III pads shall not require packaging.

5.1.3 Level C. The pads shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six packages of type I pads or three packages of type II pads or 12 each type III pads shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c, style optional. The gross weight of the fiberboard box and contents shall not exceed the weight limitations of the fiberboard box specifications. The boxes shall be closed, sealed and bonded in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six packages of type I pads or three packages of type II pads or 12 each type III pads shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic, style RSC. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 275 p.s.i. Each box shall be sealed and closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification, Method II.

5.2.3 Level C. The pads packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in container that will insure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or the National Motor Freight Classification Rules.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Sponge rubber typewriter pads conforming to this specification are intended for use under typewriters and other office machines to absorb sound and vibration.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type, size, thickness, and grade of pad required (see 1.2.1).
c. Level of packaging, packing and marking required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 84

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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